

A Time-Series Dataset of Jet Engine Fault Scenarios for Diagnostic Research

Christoforos Romesis^{a,*} and Stasinos Konstantopoulos^{a,1}

^aInstitute of Informatics and Telecommunications, NCSR Demokritos

ORCID (Christoforos Romesis): <https://orcid.org/0009-0001-6485-5548>, ORCID (Stasinos Konstantopoulos): <https://orcid.org/0000-0002-2586-1726>

Abstract. This document outlines the formatting instructions for submissions to the European Conference on Artificial Intelligence (ECAI). Use the source file as a template when writing your own paper. The abstract of your paper should be a short and accessible summary of your contribution, preferably no longer than 200 words. It should not include any references to the bibliography.

1 Introduction

Jet engines play a vital role in modern aviation, making the assurance of their operational safety and reliability a top priority. The challenging high-speed, high-temperature, and high-pressure environments in which these engines operate can compromise their integrity, leading to potential malfunctions or degraded performance of their components during flight. These faults directly impact aerothermodynamic measurements such as pressures, temperatures, and shaft speeds, which are essential for condition monitoring [3]. Detecting faults from time-series data in-flight remains a complex challenge for the research community due to limitations in available instrumentation [5], the similarity of fault effects, the possibility of multiple concurrent faults, and the influence of prior events on the development of later faults events.

In this paper, we present a dataset comprising simulated time-series measurements from a typical turbofan engine during flight. This dataset includes instances where one or more of three common faults—namely increased tip clearance (TIP), variable guide vane (VGV) mistuning, and foreign object damage (FOD)—occur. This dataset aims to facilitate the development and evaluation of fault detection strategies in aviation engine condition monitoring.

2 Motivation and Purpose

This dataset presents a valuable resource for the Machine Learning community due to its embodiment of a complex engineering problem, characterized by several distinctive features. It comprises 2,410 time series, each with 3,600 time steps. Within each series, one or more faults from a set of three are introduced, with measurements and fault labels available at every time step. Notably, some fault instances induce effects on the measurements that are nearly indistinguishable, posing significant challenges for fault differentiation. Additionally, certain faults exhibit long-term dependencies on preceding

faults, serving as critical clues for accurate identification despite similar measurement effects. These attributes render the dataset highly suitable for advancing research in sequential and time-stepwise classification, as well as for investigating long-term dependencies within time-series data.

3 Dataset Description

The dataset comprises a time series of measurements collected from a low bypass ratio turbofan engine, which is representative of contemporary in-service civil aviation engines. The dataset was generated using an Engine Performance Model (EPM) that simulates the engine's operational behavior.

3.1 Dataset Description

An EPM interrelates parameters that represent engine component health and operating conditions with measurements performed on an engine [1], and can be expressed through Equation (1):

$$\mathbf{Y} = \mathbf{g}(\mathbf{u}, \mathbf{f}) \quad (1)$$

where $\mathbf{g}$ is a vector function representing the EPM, $\mathbf{u}$ is a vector of measured quantities defining the engine's operating point, $\mathbf{Y}$ is a set of measurements for condition monitoring, and $\mathbf{f}$ is a vector of engine component *health parameters*. Typically, two health parameters are used for each component: the flow factor (SW), indicating the component's swallowing capacity, and the efficiency factor (SE), representing thermal efficiency. The application of such parameters for assessing engine component health has been discussed in [2]. A deviation of a health parameter from its nominal value signals a fault in that component. As extensively discussed in [3] the ratio of deviations between two health parameters can serve as a characteristic metric for faults such as fouling, increased tip clearance, erosion, and foreign object damage. The severity of the fault correlates with the level of this deviation. The deviation (or *delta*) of a health parameter $\Delta \mathbf{f}$ is defined as:

$$\Delta \mathbf{f} (\%) = \frac{\mathbf{f} - \mathbf{f}_o}{\mathbf{f}_o} \cdot 100\% \quad (2)$$

where $\mathbf{f}$ denotes the value of the health parameter, and $\mathbf{f}_o$ its nominal value.

* Corresponding Author. Email: chris.romesis@iit.demokritos.gr

¹ Equal contribution.

Using the EPM, the nominal values of the available measurement set, denoted as $\mathbf{Y}_o$, can be computed for a specified operating point $\mathbf{u}$. These values correspond to the nominal health parameters, $\mathbf{f}_o$, and are derived via the following relation:

$$\mathbf{Y}_o = \mathbf{g}(\mathbf{u}, \mathbf{f}_o) \quad (3)$$

Once a measurement vector $\mathbf{Y}$ is obtained from the engine, the percentage deviation (*delta*) from its nominal value $\mathbf{Y}_o$ is defined as:

$$\Delta \mathbf{Y} (\%) = \frac{\mathbf{Y} - \mathbf{Y}_o}{\mathbf{Y}_o} \cdot 100\% \quad (4)$$

To emulate realistic measurement conditions, random noise is superimposed on the measurement deviations. The noise levels considered are consistent with those typical of this instrumentation, as documented in [4].

3.2 Dataset Generation

The EPM used for dataset generation was developed in the MATLAB environment, following the approach described in [1]. At each time step, the data includes a labeled vector of measurement deltas produced by the EPM at a specified operating point (input vector $\mathbf{u}$) and a specific engine health condition (input vector $\Delta \mathbf{f}$).

A total of 10 operating points were considered, covering a broad range of the engine's flight envelope. Throughout a time series, all time steps correspond to the same operating point.

Additionally, five distinct health conditions were considered, as summarized in Table 1. The first health condition represents the nominal, healthy operation of the engine, with no deviations in health parameters across any components. The second health condition (coded as TIP) models an increased clearance of the compressor blades. As reported in [3], this fault results in a ratio of the related health parameter deviations, $\Delta SW / \Delta SE$, of 0.2; the actual deviations of ΔSW and ΔSE are approximately -1% and -5% , respectively, thereby simulating tip clearance faults of varying severity. The third health condition pertains to mistuning of the inlet guide vanes (VGV) of the compressor, analogous to the TIP fault. In these instances, deviations in the compressor's health parameters ΔSW and ΔSE typically range from approximately $+3\%$ to -1% , respectively, resulting in a ratio of -3 . The fourth health condition involves damage caused by foreign objects (FOD) within the compressor. In such cases, deviations in both health parameters are generally around -4% , yielding a ratio of 1. The fifth health condition represents the concurrent occurrence of VGV and FOD faults (denoted as VGV+FOD). The combined effect in this scenario is additive, with deviations approximately around $+1\%$ and -5% , respectively, leading to a ratio of 0.2.

Notably, the effects of TIP faults and the combined VGV+FOD faults on the compressor's health parameters are the same, and therefore, measurements under these conditions follow the same distribution. Each dataset record is labeled according to the specific health condition present at that time step.

Each time series comprises 3,600 time steps, representing measurements acquired from the engine at a frequency of 1 Hz during one hour of flight at a specific operating point. During this period, various health conditions may develop, as illustrated in Figure 1.

A time series without any fault contains measurements indicative of healthy engine operation at all time steps (labeled 1). In some time

Table 1. Considered health conditions.

AISB-1980	Amsterdam	ECAI-1990	Stockholm
ECAI-2000	Berlin	ECAI-2010	Lisbon
ECAI-2020	Santiago de Compostela (online)		

series, the engine operates fault-free initially (time steps labeled 1), but at a certain point, a TIP fault occurs and persists until the end of the series (time steps labeled 2). Similarly, there are series where the engine functions without faults initially (time steps 1), but subsequently a VGV or FOD fault occurs, remaining until the series concludes (time steps labeled 3 or 4, respectively). In some other time series, the engine also operates fault-free initially (time steps labeled 1), but at a certain point, a brief period (approximately 10 time steps) occurs during which a VGV fault is present. The engine then continues to operate without faults until a later time step, when a combined VGV+FOD fault manifests and persists for the remainder of the time series. This scenario exemplifies a specific fault condition characterized by a severe VGV fault leading to FOD. The damage is attributed to the detachment of a particle from the VGV mechanism, such as a loosened bolt, which is subsequently ingested by the engine. The failure of the VGV mechanism may be preceded by a transient VGV fault event, serving as an early indicator of the impending failure. This scenario was selected because both the TIP and VGV+FOD faults exert similar impacts on engine performance. The key differentiator between the TIP fault and the VGV+FOD fault is the long-term dependency of the latter on the initial, instantaneous VGV fault.



Figure 1. Development of health conditions during a time-series of the dataset.

3.3 Dataset Characteristics

The dataset is available in compressed CSV format (csv.gz) at ... Figure 2 shows the first lines of the CSV file for illustration, displaying the header and the first three records of the dataset. Table 2 describes the contents of each record.



Figure 2. First lines of the csv file of the dataset.

4 Conclusions

his scenario exemplifies a specific fault condition characterized by a severe VGV fault leading to FOD. The damage is attributed to the detachment of a particle from the VGV mechanism, such as a loosened bolt, which is subsequently ingested by the engine. The failure of the VGV mechanism may be preceded by a transient VGV fault event, serving as an early indicator of the impending failure.

Table 2. Contents of the dataset’s records.

AISB-1980	Amsterdam	ECAI-1990	Stockholm
ECAI-2000	Berlin	ECAI-2010	Lisbon
ECAI-2020	Santiago de Compostela (online)		

References

- [1] A. Alexiou and K. Mathioudakis. Development of Gas Turbine Performance Models Using a Generic Simulation Tool. In *Volume 1: Turbo Expo 2005*, Reno, Nevada, USA, Jan. 2005. ASMEDC. doi: 10.1115/gt2005-68678. URL <https://asmedigitalcollection.asme.org/GT/proceedings/GT2005/46997/185/363560>.
- [2] K. Mathioudakis, A. Stamatis, A. Tsalavoutas, and N. Aretakis. Performance analysis of industrial gas turbines for engine condition monitoring. *Proceedings of the Institution of Mechanical Engineers, Part A: Journal of Power and Energy*, 215(2):173–184, Jan. 2001. ISSN 0957-6509, 2041-2967. doi: 10.1243/0957650011538442. URL <https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/10.1243/0957650011538442>. Publisher: SAGE Publications.
- [3] K. Mathioudakis, A. Alexiou, N. Aretakis, and C. Romesis. Signatures of Compressor and Turbine Faults in Gas Turbine Performance Diagnostics: A Review. *Energies*, 17(14):3409, July 2024. ISSN 1996-1073. doi: 10.3390/en17143409. URL <https://www.mdpi.com/1996-1073/17/14/3409>. Publisher: MDPI AG.
- [4] C. Romesis, N. Aretakis, and K. Mathioudakis. Model-Assisted Probabilistic Neural Networks for Effective Turbofan Fault Diagnosis. *Aerospace*, 11(11):913, Nov. 2024. ISSN 2226-4310. doi: 10.3390/aerospace11110913. URL <https://www.mdpi.com/2226-4310/11/11/913>. Publisher: MDPI AG.
- [5] L. A. Urban. Gas Path Analysis Applied to Turbine Engine Condition Monitoring. *Journal of Aircraft*, 10(7):400–406, July 1973. ISSN 0021-8669, 1533-3868. doi: 10.2514/3.60240. URL <https://arc.aiaa.org/doi/10.2514/3.60240>. Publisher: American Institute of Aeronautics and Astronautics (AIAA).